

Zhonghang LI

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EDUCATION

- **Australian National University, Master of Financial Management** Canberra, Australia
GPA:6.375/7, Second Class, Division I 02/2024 – 07/2025
- **Northwest A&F University, Bachelor of Economics (“985 Project”)** Shaanxi, China
GPA:78.27/100, Second Class, Division I 09/2018 – 06/2022

PUBLICATION & RESEARCH PAPERS

Zhonghang Li., The Impact of the Digital Economy on Carbon Emissions: Evidence from Machine Learning, Graph Neural Networks, and the EKC Hypothesis, *Research in World Economy*

- **Abstract:** This study uses panel data from 30 provinces in China from 2007 to 2023, combined with machine learning and GNN, to investigate the spatial dynamics of carbon emissions, aiming to assess the impact path of the digital economy on carbon intensity. Empirical evidence shows that the digital economy significantly reduces carbon intensity with heterogeneity. GNN predictions are superior to traditional methods. Carbon intensity has time inertia and negative spatial spillover. The spatial diffusion capacity of the digital economy varies by region. The research provides support for emission reduction policies. *Beyond Connectivity: How Digital Economy Shapes Regional Innovation?*

Fei Song, **Zhonghang Li**, et al. **Digital economy and green total factor productivity of SMEs, *International Review of Financial Analysis* (JCR Q1, IF:9.8), Accepted**

- **Abstract:** This paper uses the panel data of Chinese listed companies from 2007 to 2022 to study the impact of the digital economy on the GTFP of small and medium-sized enterprises. Principal component analysis is used to build a digital economy index, and multiple models are employed to address endogeneity. It is found that there is a significant positive correlation between the two. Financing constraints play a partial mediating role, green innovation regulates and amplifies positive impacts, and research provides insights for achieving relevant goals.

He Xu, Dong Li, **Zhonghang Li**, et al. **Beyond Connectivity: How Digital Economy Shapes Regional Innovation? *International Review of Economics&Finance*(JCR Q1, IF:5.6)**

- **Abstract:** This paper examines the impact of digital economy development on regional innovation capacity using panel data from 30 Chinese provinces during 2011–2023. A two-way fixed-effects model with multiple endogeneity controls confirms a significant positive effect of digitalization on innovation. Mediation results show that R&D intensity partially explains this relationship. In addition, financial development and fiscal support amplify the innovation benefits of the digital economy. The findings suggest that coordinated digital investment, financial development, and fiscal policies are crucial for enhancing regional innovation capacity.

Zhonghang Li., The Impact of Digital Economy Development on Household Consumption: Mechanisms, Heterogeneity, and COVID-19 Effects in China, *Applied Economics* (JCR Q2, IF:2.1), Major revision

- **Abstract:** This paper uses the micro-panel data of Chinese households from 2018 to 2022 to study the relationship between the digital economy and household consumption through multiple models, and analyzes the influencing pathways, gaps and the impact of the epidemic. It is found that the digital economy can boost consumption with diminishing marginal effects, and its impact on the central region and other areas is more obvious. The epidemic has weakened its role, and the research provides experience and suggestions.

- **Abstract:** This paper uses the data of A-share listed companies in China from 2010 to 2023 and measures the adoption of AI through the analysis of annual report texts. It is found that AI is strongly positively correlated with OFDI. AI promotes OFDI through three intermediary channels, amplifies the impact of regional business environments, etc., and is more significant for large enterprises and technology-intensive industries. The research contributes to relevant literature.

Bachelor’s Thesis: *Excessive Debt in Rural Households of Shaanxi: Economic Characteristics and Resolution Mechanisms*

- **Abstract:** The growth of income and consumption of rural families in China is accompanied by some excessive debts. This study takes the overly indebted rural families in Shaanxi Province as the object and uses the logistic model to analyse the impact of family economic characteristics on the debt scale. It was found that the proportion was relatively small, with rigid expenditures such as housing being the main cause. The asset scale and other aspects were positively correlated with debt and negatively correlated with liquidity. Moreover, the Engel's coefficient of such families was high, and they needed to ensure a basic living standard.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law (Research Assistant) 11/2023 – 01/2024

- **Main Contributions:**
 - Studied and summarised relevant literature and industry reports, extracted filtered data, and conducted data analysis and robustness tests using Stata.
 - Collected domestic and foreign academic literature, policy documents and other materials to assist in the writing of research reports.
 - Prepared research report PPTs, co-ordinated and organised seminars, undertook and implemented other research support tasks.

Northwest A&F University - “Excessive Debt in Rural Households of Shaanxi: Economic Characteristics and Resolution Mechanisms” Project 03/2021 – 06/2022

- **Main Contributions:**
 - Designed the survey and conducted on-site interviews, standardised the dataset to ensure data accuracy.
 - Sorted out academic and policy literature and integrated the materials to provide support for the project’s research framework.

Northwest A&F University - “An Empirical Study on Risk Perception, Insurance Awareness, and Risk-Bearing Capacity of Farmers” Project 08/2021 – 10/2021

- **Main Contributions:**
 - Designed the investigation plan and conducted on-site interviews, cleaned up and standardised the data set to ensure the accuracy of the information.
 - Integrated academic and policy literature materials, and extracted key contents to provide support for the research framework.

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCES

Industrial Securities (Wuhan)

Wuhan, China

Financial Adviser Intern

07/2021 – 08/2021

- Carried out customer acquisition and relationship maintenance work, and provided professional investment consulting services to customers.
- Developed personalised financial planning schemes and promoted related business of financial product sales.
- Assisted the consulting team in identifying over 20 potential clients and drove a 10% increase in the team's sales performance

Huangchuan Branch of China Construction Bank

Xinyang, China

Intern

05/2020 – 07/2020

- Processed and analysed financial data, drafted internal documents and correspondence, and ensured the accuracy and clarity of the documents.
- Assisted in organising working meetings, and coordinated cross-departmental administrative affairs.
- Helped enhance departmental efficiency, facilitated timely communication within the team, and promoted decision-making and project execution.

VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCE

- Volunteered as a Psychological Support Volunteer since July 2025, motivated by my own recovery from a severe burn injury in April 2025, to provide empathetic listening and emotional support both online and in-person.

SKILLS & HOBBIES

- **Languages:** Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese(basic)
- **Software Skills:** R, Stata, Python
- **Economic Analysis:** Strong capability in applying theoretical frameworks to interpret market dynamics and policy impacts.
- **Quantitative Research:** Proficiency in using statistical tools and econometric models to derive evidence-based insights.
- **Policy Evaluation:** Aptitude for assessing the effectiveness of economic policies and their broader societal implications.
- **Data-Driven Decision-Making:** Ability to integrate data analysis with economic reasoning to support strategic planning.
- **Global Perspective:** Competence in examining economic issues within the interconnected framework of international trade and finance..
- **Hobbies:** Long-Distance running especially in half marathon.